

# The Boston Globe

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## New scourge for Lewiston — guns and teens

City of mass shooting sets curfew, reaches out to parents, students to stem violence

By Kevin Cullen  
GLOBE STAFF

LEWISTON, Maine — On a recent evening in a school cafeteria, parents sat at tables where their children usually have lunch, as the police chief and school superintendent flashed slides on a screen — photos of a 9mm pistol, a replica .357 revolver, and more.

Police officers explained what certain guns look like and encouraged parents to search their kids' rooms. They should look for guns like these, and for drugs, the officials said as interpreters translated

the proceedings for some parents whose native languages include Somali, Swahili, Portuguese, and Spanish.

The meeting was one of dozens of similar gatherings as authorities here try to combat a dramatic rise in gun violence.

The horrific mass shootings in October 2023 that left 18 people dead and another dozen wounded put Lewiston on an unenviable map of cities that have endured one of America's high-profile, signature pathologies. But Lewiston has for much of the last decade struggled

more quietly with a rise in gun violence among young people, prompting a host of measures in recent months, including a curfew and a police tip line to report violence.

In a city where some 10 percent of the population is foreign-born, many of the victims and perpetrators of youth violence are the children of the African immigrants who helped revitalize this old mill city two decades ago. And enlisting their parents in the fight against youth violence is a key goal of city officials and community advocates.

The number of shootings in the city, many of them involving teenagers, has more than tripled over the last seven years, according to police

LEWISTON, Page A10

Gun violence in the city began to increase dramatically around 2018, when there were 18 reported shootings.

27  
2021

42  
2022

38  
2023

35  
2024

71

number of guns police took off the street last year. So far this year there is a similar pace of seizures.

## Group deported in face of court order

Trump uses wartime act for alleged gang members despite ruling by judge

By Devlin Barrett, Annie Correal, and William K. Rashbaum

NEW YORK TIMES

The Trump administration sent hundreds of Venezuelans accused of being gang members to a prison in El Salvador, pushing the limits of immigration law by potentially carrying out the deportations after a federal judge ordered that the flights not proceed.

While the precise timing of the deportations over the weekend remained unclear, the Trump administration denied it had violated the court order, saying that the president had broad powers to quickly expel them under an 18th-century law meant for wartime.

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt also asserted in a statement that the federal courts “have no jurisdiction” over the president's conduct of foreign affairs or his power to expel foreign enemies.

“A single judge in a single city cannot direct the movements of an aircraft carrier full of foreign alien terrorists who were physically expelled from U.S. soil,” she said in a statement. It was unclear why she referred to an aircraft carrier, because all indications were that the Venezuelans had been

REMOVALS, Page A6

### Doctor deported

A federal judge demanded answers after US officials deported a doctor despite his order that she not be removed until he could hear her case. **B1.**

## The cost of chaos in today's business world

Retailers, wholesalers say tariff turmoil carries a price

By Janelle Nanos

GLOBE STAFF

When a tsunami struck Japan 14 years ago this month, Jeff Morrill knew the aftereffects would ripple halfway around the world to his car dealerships in Franklin and Hanover.

The natural disaster was certain to upend the supply chain of vehicles from Japanese automakers, so Morrill and his partner, Dale Lathrop, scrambled to buy as much inventory as they could for their Planet Subaru and Planet Chrysler Jeep Dodge Ram dealerships.

“We knew as soon as that happened that it was going to impact the production of vehicles,” Morrill said. “There are things we can do.”

Today, facing a tsunami of an entirely different kind, Morrill and Lathrop have no such plan.

Over the past several weeks, they've watched the Trump administration announce tariffs, then

UNCERTAINTY, Page A7



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Roca outreach worker Mischael Morency tried to connect with a client at his home in Boston. For Morency, his work offered a chance for redemption, along with a chance to help others get a handle on the problems that initially troubled him.

## AT-RISK: YOUTH PROGRAMS

Freeze of federal funds threatens groups fighting bloodshed, helping victims

By Dan Glaun

GLOBE STAFF

At 11:30 on a bright and frigid recent morning, youth outreach worker Mischael Morency stood on the front porch of a Dorchester duplex, waiting for 20-year-old Josiah Ancrum to come downstairs. Morency knocked. He called Ancrum's phone, talking over the continuous barks of a small dog, yapping from inside the home.

“I'm basically like a stalker at this point,” said Morency, 26, who works for the antiviolence nonprofit Roca Inc.

Roca's youth outreach efforts, part of its work to prevent gun violence, is painstaking, hands-on. It is also sub-



Morency (right) and Josiah Ancrum, 20, talked through the issues and struggles that Ancrum had been facing.

stantially funded by federal grants, which could be in jeopardy as a result of President Trump's efforts to pause spending and cut programs that support marginalized groups.

This uncertainty threatens to undercut Roca's work and that of other social-service organizations across Boston. Officials describe their efforts as key to the city's antiviolence efforts, helping Boston reach historically low homicide and shooting rates.

“Boston is the safest major city in the country due to the strong partnerships between our Boston Police Department, community organizations and residents

ROCA, Page A7

## Two utilities join alliance with fossil fuel lobby

By Sabrina Shankman

GLOBE STAFF

Last year, two major energy companies working in Massachusetts joined the ranks of an innocuous sounding group: the Consumer Energy Alliance. The organization calls itself “the voice of the energy consumer,” while espousing the “all-of-the-above” approach to energy — oil, natural gas, wind, and solar.

But, according to financial documents, the alliance was formed and is operated by a fossil fuel lobbying group based in Houston. Its stated purpose includes “the promotion and defense of natural gas.”

Across the country, the alliance has fought the kinds of climate policies that are taking root in Massachusetts. And in some cases, it has done so by claiming that those policies harm people of color — a claim that overlooks studies showing how

GAS GROUPS, Page A10



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

**SMILING EYES** — It was a day of shamrocks, wearing of the green, and, of course, the Southie St. Patrick's Day Parade. Thousands turned out for the annual event, which followed the traditional breakfast that features roasts, as in politicians. **B1.**



### The yuck of the Irish

**Monday:** Heavy rains, winds. High 57-62, low 38-43.

**Tuesday:** Sun returns, cooler. High 49-54, low 36-41.

Sunrise: 6:52. Sunset: 6:53.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C10.**

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**Another office tower in downtown Boston is being put on the market** amid falling prices after the COVID-19 pandemic cut demand for office space. **D1.**

**High school champions were crowned** on the court and the rink, **C6-8.**

**Mass. nonprofits fear a plan to limit tax deductions for donations** will batter their bottom lines. **D1.**

**Unleash the madness:** NCAA brackets for basketball glory have been set. **C1.**

**The head of Metco is stepping down** from the voluntary integration program for students. **B1.**

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